

Waygr — Product brief

Sep 24, 2026 · Part of the Waygr doc set: PRODUCT-BRIEF, GROWTH-LOOP, BRAND-BRIEF, BUILD-BRIEF

Summary

Waygr is a free app for calling your shot against a friend on a live game. You drop a challenge into the group chat, your friend accepts from the link without installing anything, the score feed settles it, and the loser owes a forfeit the app puts on display. No money moves through the app.

Marketing is built into the product, not bolted on after. Every challenge needs a second person, so every challenge sent to someone new is an invite, and every result is a card made to be shared. The Growth loop doc specs that loop and how to measure it.

The doc set, pressure-tested against what a small agent team needs to ship a viral app:

Doc	Who uses it	Why it's needed
Product brief (this doc)	You, anyone who joins	Locks what Waygr is and isn't, so agents don't drift
Growth loop	You and Argos	Virality is the goal, so the loop gets designed and measured like a feature
Brand brief	Designer bot	The share cards are the marketing; they need a look before they get built
Build brief	Argos and the coding agents	Standfast format: phases, locked decisions, data model, acceptance criteria, prompt to paste

Left out on purpose: business plan, market sizing, pitch deck and financial model. None of them changes what gets built for a hobby launch, and the numbers that matter (invite conversion, rematch rate) won't exist until beta. Legal is cut to four product guardrails.

Three calls for you are at the bottom under Open decisions.

First principles

The job hasn't changed since 2016: friends want to back their take on a game against each other, with something on the line, and win the argument in front of the group. Today that's a text ("loser buys wings"), then forgotten terms, an argument about the result, and nobody collecting.

What changed is everything around the job:

Then (2016)	Now (2026)	What it means for Waygr
Both people had to install a native app	A link opens a fast web app straight from the group chat	Accept from the link, no install; native comes later
Building well took a funded team months	An agent team ships a PWA in weeks	Scope is limited by judgment, not engineering cost
Live scores meant scraping or pricey feeds	Hobby-tier feeds run free to about \$40 a month	Every challenge settles itself; nobody self-reports
Sports betting was illegal almost everywhere	Legal in 39 states and D.C.; prediction markets are mainstream	People already speak spreads, overs and props
Marketing meant ads and PR	Growth comes from things shared in group chats and short video	The product has to make things worth sharing

Product principles, used to break ties:

1. The challenge is the product. Everything else serves making, accepting or settling one.
2. Nothing stands between the link and "You're on." No install, no profile setup, one-tap sign-in.
3. The feed is the referee. No disputes, no self-reporting.
4. Stakes are social, not financial. Losers owe a forfeit the app enforces in public.
5. Every result makes something shareable.
6. Rivalries, not streaks. The running head-to-head record is what brings people back.

From the 2016 wireframe, the challenge itself and most of the prop menu survive (quarter winner, halftime leader, spread), joined by game winner and total. "Points at X minutes" is cut because feeds don't reliably timestamp scores. Charging the loser, drinks as stakes, bar-side redemption, scanner hardware and the business dashboard are gone.

Core loop and v1 scope

v1 is one loop done well: make a challenge, get it accepted from a link, watch it live, settle it, pay the forfeit, rematch.

```
flowchart LR
    A[Pick a game<br/>and your call] --> B[Pick a forfeit]
    B --> C[Share the link<br/>to a friend or chat]
    C --> D[Friend accepts<br/>no install]
    D --> E[Live page<br/>both watch]
    E --> F[Feed settles it]
    F --> G[Result card<br/>and forfeit]
    G --> H[Rematch]
    H --> A
```

The forfeit replaces "loser is charged" as the enforcement. Three kinds ship in v1:

- **Concession card.** The loser sends a pre-written card to the chat ("I was wrong about the Cowboys. —Jordan"). One tap from the result screen.
- **Jersey swap.** The loser's avatar wears the winner's team frame for 7 days. Automatic; it can't be skipped.
- **Custom.** The challenger writes it ("wear his jersey to the next watch party"). The loser posts a photo or video as proof and the winner confirms.

Unpaid forfeits show as "Owes 1" on the loser's profile, and everyone's paid rate is public. Welching costs reputation, which is the only currency Waygr has.

Feature	Phase
1v1 challenge by link: game winner, spread, total, halftime leader, quarter winner	1
Accept in the browser with Sign in with Apple, Google or a phone code	1
Auto-settle from the feed, ties included; void on postponed or canceled games	1
Live challenge page: score, both calls, time left, trash-talk thread	1
Forfeits: concession card, jersey swap, custom with proof	1
Result cards as images, rematch in one tap, rivalry record per pair	1
Web push once the PWA is on the home screen	1
Group challenges ("who's in?") and group leaderboards	2

Rooms: a QR on the TV or a table card puts everyone into one live board	2
Native iOS app: iMessage extension, Live Activities on the lock screen, widgets	3
Money, drinks or anything with cash value as a stake	Never

What's out there

Nobody owns the fast one-on-one challenge between friends that settles itself and makes the loser pay up in public. The closest products need real money, a bar, or a season-long league.

Product	What it is	Why it doesn't do Waygr's job
Wagr	Real-money betting with friends; licensed in Tennessee, about \$16M raised	Shut its app in late 2022, then sold to Yahoo. Money meant licenses state by state
WagerLab	Free friend-betting app out of Houston, plus white-label games for sports bars	Both sides install an app; tracking, no enforced stakes
Sports-IQ	Live sports trivia with a leaderboard for your bar, QR check-in	Trivia against the room, not calls against a friend
BarSharp	Free live prop game at participating bars, with prizes	Bar-bound; you against a leaderboard
Buzztime	The original bar game network, since 1985	Sold for \$2M in 2020 ; runs on venue sales
BeTeam , Gamby , Trofeo	Season-long pick'em pools for a group	One pick a week; no head-to-head moment
Kalshi , Polymarket , Novig	Real-money prediction markets, available in Texas	Money against strangers, the opposite of a friendly stake

The lesson from Wagr: [a bet nobody takes goes unmatched](#), and a dead end kills the loop. A Waygr challenge lands in a chat that's already talking about the game, and anyone in that chat can take the other side.

Guardrails

Four product rules. They cost nothing on a hobby build and are painful to retrofit later.

- **No money, drinks or anything with cash value as a stake, and nothing moves through the app.** In Texas, recording more than five bets on something of value in a day meets the [statutory definition of bookmaking](#), and [bars can lose their permit](#) over gambling on premises. Social stakes keep rooms in bars possible.
- **Forfeits never involve alcohol, money or risk of injury.** The built-in set is curated; custom forfeits are screened (rules in the build brief).
- **18+ to sign up.**
- **No prizes in v1.** If a bar or brand wants to put up prizes later, that's a separate free-to-play contest, and it gets an hour of legal review first.

Open decisions

- Clear the name with your friend who ran [the first Waygr](#): his OK to reuse it, and who holds waygr.com and the @waygr_app handles. Yahoo owns Wagr, a sound-alike in the same category; fine for a hobby, worth a trademark search before any public launch.
- Pick three to five seed group chats for the private beta (criteria in Growth loop).
- Confirm the beta target: the Thanksgiving NFL slate, Nov 26, 2026.

Risks to watch from week one:

- **Seasonality.** Use will spike on NFL Sundays and in March, then sag in summer. NBA and MLB coverage plus the rivalry record have to carry the gaps.
- **Welching.** If losers ignore forfeits, stakes feel fake. Track the paid rate; if it drops below half, make forfeits more automatic.
- **iOS push.** Web push only works after someone adds the PWA to their home screen, so the first accept can't depend on it. The link and the chat carry Phase 1.

Sources

- [Tex. Penal Code §47.01, definitions](#)
- [TABC public safety and enforcement FAQs](#)
- [RotoWire: Texas sports betting status, July 2026](#)

- [Sports Illustrated: Texas prediction markets, September 2026](#)
- [Sports Handle: Yahoo acquires Wagr](#)
- [BettingUSA: Wagr review](#)
- [Crunchbase: WagerLab](#) · [Crunchbase: Waygr \(closed\)](#)
- [Sports-IQ on the App Store](#) · [BarSharp on the App Store](#)
- [Buzztime](#) · [Buzztime asset sale, 2020](#)
- [BeTeam](#) · [Gamby](#) · [Trofeo](#)
- [BALLDONTLIE](#) · [SharpAPI provider comparison](#)
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